

Lathamus discolor

Swift parrot



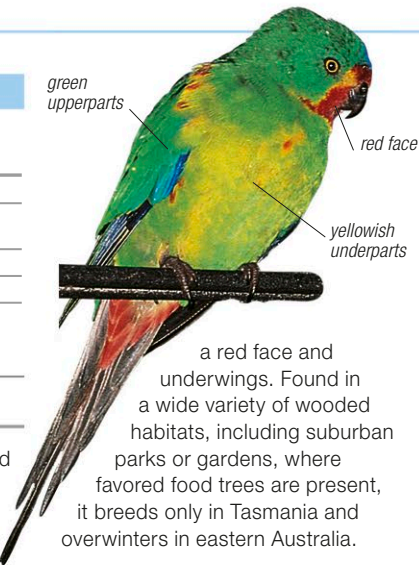
Location E. and S.E. Australia

Length 10 in (25 cm)
Weight 2½ oz (65 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant

Status Critically endangered



Long, pointed wings and a streamlined shape contribute to making this small parrot a fast flier, hence its name. Its crown is dark blue, contrasting with



a red face and underwings. Found in a wide variety of wooded habitats, including suburban parks or gardens, where favored food trees are present, it breeds only in Tasmania and overwinters in eastern Australia.

Deroptyus accipitrinus

Red-fan parrot



Location N. South America

Length 14 in (35 cm)
Weight 8 oz (225 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant

Status Least concern



This parrot is distinguished by dark red feathers that extend from the nape to the hind neck. When excited or alarmed, it raises its neck feathers to form a spectacular ruff or fan. Its long, rounded tail is also a distinctive



characteristic. While perching, the red-fan parrot resembles a bird of prey, with its hawklike eyes. Usually seen in pairs or small groups (rarely of up to 20 birds), this forest-dwelling parrot is inconspicuous but is often heard well before it comes into view.

Strigops habroptila

Kakapo



Location New Zealand (4 offshore islands)

Length 25 in (64 cm)
Weight 4½ lb (2 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant

Status Critically endangered



One of the world's most endangered parrots, the flightless kakapo has highly unusual feeding habits. It is active at dusk and often walks long distances to feeding areas where it chews plants for their juices, leaving balls of fibrous material hanging from the plants. It also digs up or crushes rhizomes with its bill. The males gather at mating grounds (leks), where they dig hollows, and make loud, booming noises to attract females. The adults, chicks, and eggs of the kakapo are highly vulnerable to introduced predators.



Pyrilia aurantiocephala

Bald parrot



Location C. South America

Length 8½–10 in (22–25 cm)
Weight Not known
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant

Status Near threatened



The bald parrot—so-called because of the bare, bristly head with bright orange skin—occurs in scattered locations in gallery forest of central Amazonian Brazil. When specimens of this remarkable parrot were first collected, they were thought to be juveniles of the allied vulturine parrot (*Pyrilia vulturina*), which has a black, bare head and lives in the same region and habitat as the bald parrot. They were later demonstrated to be mature birds of a new species—scientifically described in 2002. It is possible that the bare head of these parrots allows them to feed on sticky fruit without soiling their feathers—like bare-headed vultures are protected from gore while feeding on carcasses. Both bald and vulturine parrots are short-tailed with predominantly green plumage; the bare head is only achieved in adulthood.

Melopsittacus undulatus

Budgerigar



Location Australia

Length 7 in (18 cm)
Weight 7½ oz (25 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nomadic

Status Least concern



The budgerigar is one of the most numerous of all parrots and is the best known because of its popularity as a pet. Unlike its domesticated counterparts, which may be of different



colors, the wild budgerigar is always green, with a yellow face and blue tail. The upperparts of its body are barred black and yellow, providing excellent camouflage while it feeds in vegetation. Often nomadic, this bird is usually seen in large, noisy flocks.

Psittacus erithacus

Gray parrot



Location W. to C. Africa

Length 13 in (33 cm)
Weight 14 oz (400 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant

Status Endangered



This stocky, short-tailed parrot is an extremely popular cage bird because of its ability to imitate human speech and perform tricks. Despite being illegally trapped for the pet trade, it is still common in parts of its range. It is found mainly in lowland rain forest,



and also in montane rainforest, at forest edges, on plantations, and on farmland or in gardens. It has unusual coloration, its gray plumage contrasting strongly with the bright red or deep maroon of the tail. In flight, members of the flock continually call to each other and also communicate visually by displaying their red tails.

Agapornis personatus

Yellow-collared lovebird



Location E. Africa (Tanzania)

Length 5¾ in (14.5 cm)
Weight 1¾ oz (50 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant

Status Least concern



Lovebirds get their name from their strong pair-bonds, with the male and female spending much of their time close together, frequently preening each other's feathers. All 9 species are small, short-tailed, and solidly built. The yellow-collared lovebird has a dark head, with a conspicuous white eye-ring and bright red bill. It feeds on seeds, fruit, and buds, and, unusually for a parrot, builds a nest instead of laying its eggs in an unlined hole.



Amazona aestiva

Turquoise-fronted Amazon



Location C. South America

Length 14½ in (37 cm)
Weight 14 oz (400 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant

Status Least concern



A distinctive blue forehead on a yellow face differentiates this large and stocky parrot from other members of the genus *Amazona*, of which there are about 30 species. Although conspicuous and noisy in flight, the turquoise-fronted Amazon parrot is unobtrusive and quiet while feeding or resting in treetops, where falling pieces of fruit may be the only indication of its presence. Birds gather in flocks at regular nighttime roosts, but mated pairs always stay close together.

